



2-Way Email Research Findings

Sunny Choi | Talent Acquisition UX | May 2025

Recording Link Password:



Agenda

01

Overview

Research background, User Type, Study Details

02

Research Questions

Questions asked during testing

03

Executive Summary

Overall summary of the test

04

Detailed Feedback by Task

Feedback received from each task asked to complete

05

UX Recommendations

UX Recommendations and possible scope for MVP

06

Next Steps

Next steps for the team

Background

As a follow up from the past DPG's, this testing was done to understand **detailed user feedback on the current high fidelity designs** for the 2-Way Conversational Email feature.

Research plans were consulted with Christine Wozniak (Sr Researcher).

Related Research

Previous [DPG Notes](#)

User Type

Our User

HR Professionals who are currently familiar with Workday

	User Type	User's Focus	Workday Usage	Workday Transaction Volume	Workday Experience Influence
Frontstage	Worker	Doing things for me	Transactional tasks	Very high	Low
	Manager	Doing things for my team	Oversight and planning tools	High	
	Business Leader	Doing things for the business	Snapshot of business-critical data	Medium	
	HR Professional	Doing things for my job	Core business technology	Medium	
	Fin Professional	Doing things for my job	Core business technology	Medium	
Backstage	Enabler	Managing the system strategy at customer	Solution strategy	Low	High
	Configurator	Managing the system strategy at customer	'Under the hood'	Low	
	Developer	Expanding the system's capabilities	Platform for development	Low	

Study Details

Participants

- 7 US based TA Professionals from



accenture

- 3 Japan based TA Professionals from

Rakuten

YOKOGAWA 

Methodology

- **45-minute moderated usability test** with existing customers from DPG's

Study Assets

[Study Plan](#)

[Prototypes](#)

[Research Findings & Links](#)

Research Questions

Overall Feedback on the MVP Flows

- How would you complete these tasks?
 - Opening email
 - Filtering/Finding email
 - Creating new email
 - Adding message templates

Discussion on Functionalities

- What required functionalities are missing?
- What future functionalities would you like and why?

SUS Evaluation

- 4 Rating questions on a scale of 1 through 5 on...
 - Expected Usage Frequency
 - Ease of Use
 - Confidence
 - Expected time/effort needed to learn the system

Executive Summary

Key Takeaways

Overall Impression

“I’m surprised that this is not a feature already in Workday.”

Ease of Use

Overall participants thought the system was easy to use and intuitive.

Unknown Functionalities

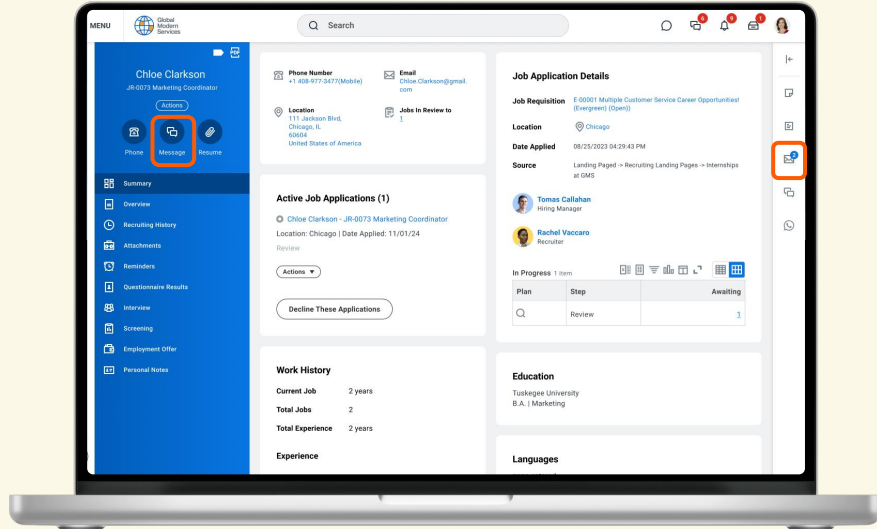
Participants lost confidence on the following unknown functionalities... :

- From field modification
- Attachments
- Threads
- Sync to Outlook/Gmail

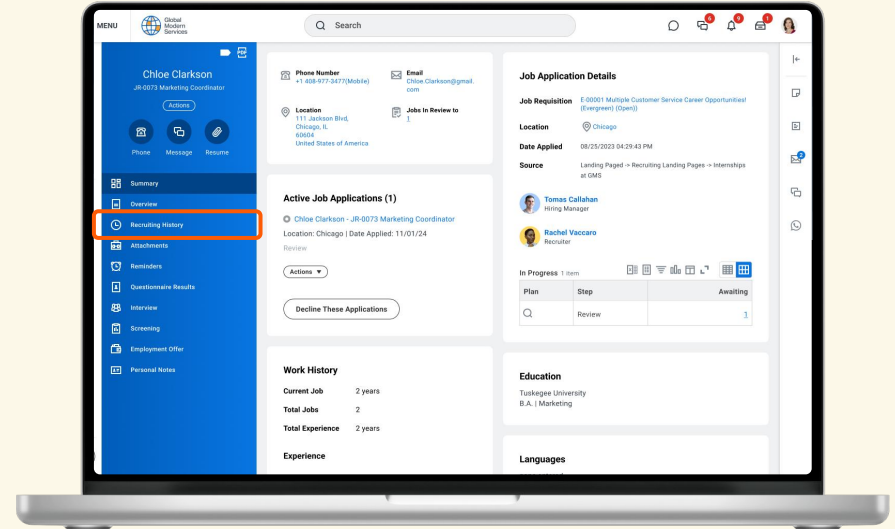
Detailed Feedback & Recommendations

Finding Emails

Because of the existing 1-way email functionality, many participants said they would go to “Recruiting History” to find email history.



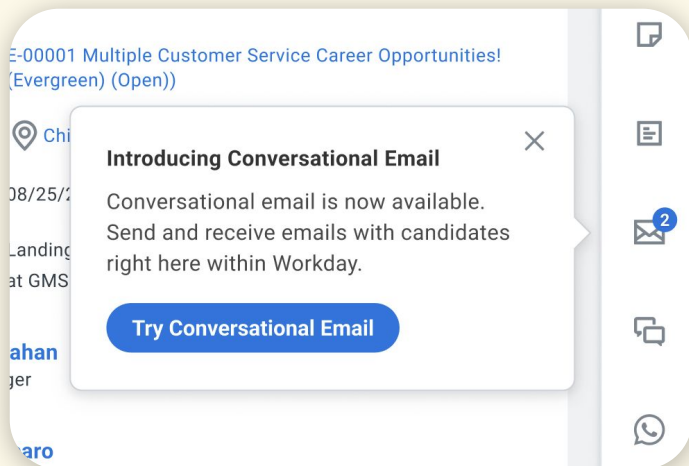
Expected



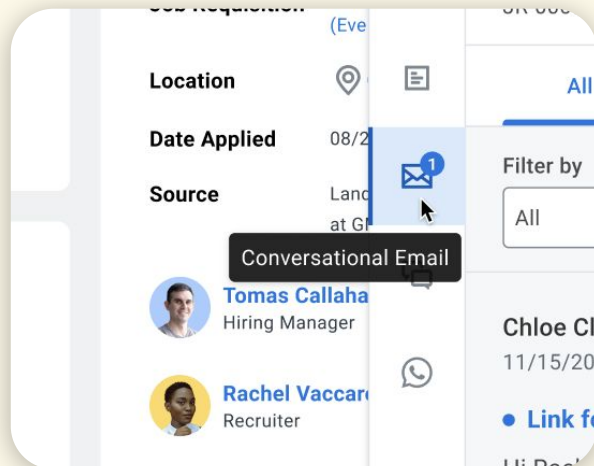
Where most users actually clicked

Finding Emails

Recommendations

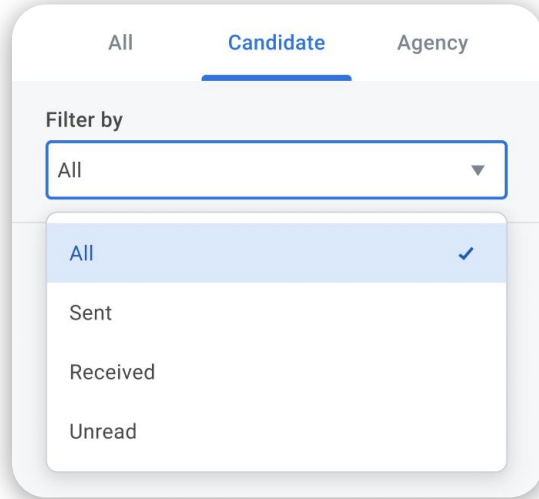


Consider more ways to highlight new feature such as feature highlight



Provide hover state tooltip

Filtering

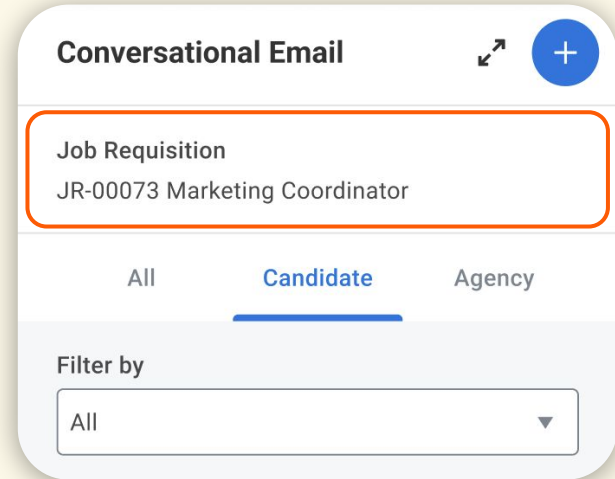


All users had no major issues interacting with candidate vs. agency tabs and filters.

Some other filtering options suggested were: Important & Flagged

Handling Multiple Job Reqs

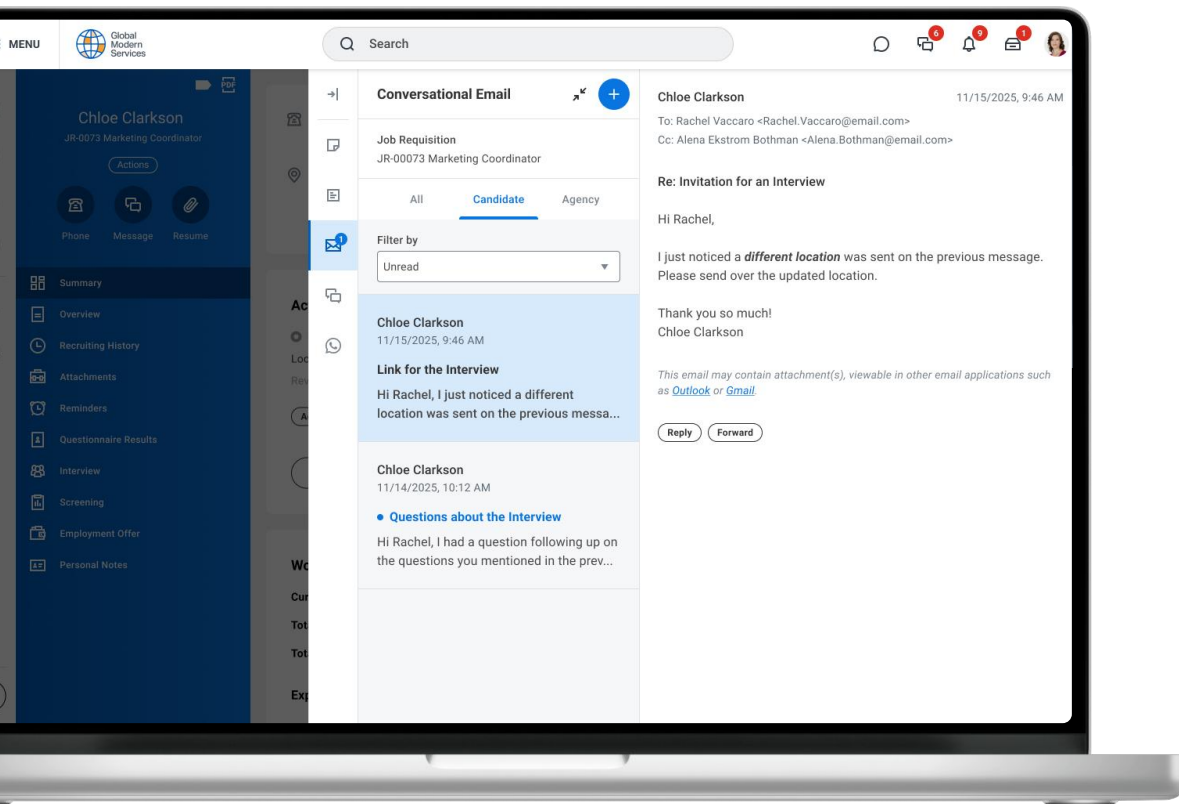
- Most participants wanted to **view all emails** from a candidate, with a functionality to **filter by each job requisition**.
- One participant mentioned that in their previous ATS, they were able to tag each email with a job requisition to sort by each job req later.



Handling Multiple Job Reqs

Recommendations

- Consider being able to **tag** each email by job req in the future to **view only by specific job reqs**
- Further research needed on how to handle **multiple** job requisitions
- Technical constraints or feedback would be helpful



Opening Email

All users had no major issues interacting/opening up emails.

Most users understood that the blue subject line, number and dot signify unread emails.

Attachments

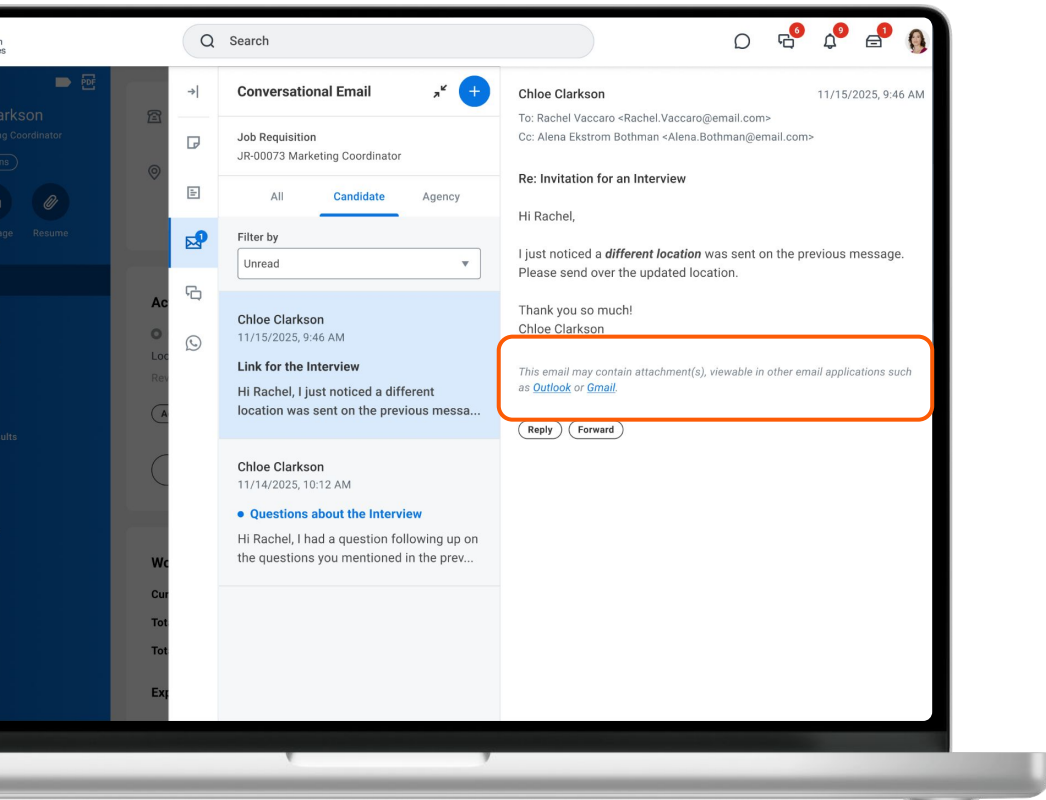
Many recruiters said receiving attachments from candidates is a **common use case**, although not a daily occurrence. Examples of attachments are...

- Updated Resumes
- Referral Letters
- Signed Offers
- NDA's, Agreements
- Benefits Documents

“It looks like the system doesn't support attachments, which would be a **big hindrance**.

- Lauren Bolsinger, Nissan US”

Attachments - MVP



Everyone understood what this statement meant, and said that they would expect it to open up Outlook App, and even **this specific email** to open when blue link texts are clicked.

Attachments

Recommendations

- Since attachments are frequently sent from and to candidates, this should be a **fast-follow post-MVP**.
- When user clicks on Outlook or Gmail links, if possible, we should aim to open up **specific emails** from each app to reduce friction.

This email may contain attachment(s), viewable in other email applications such as [Outlook](#) or [Gmail](#).

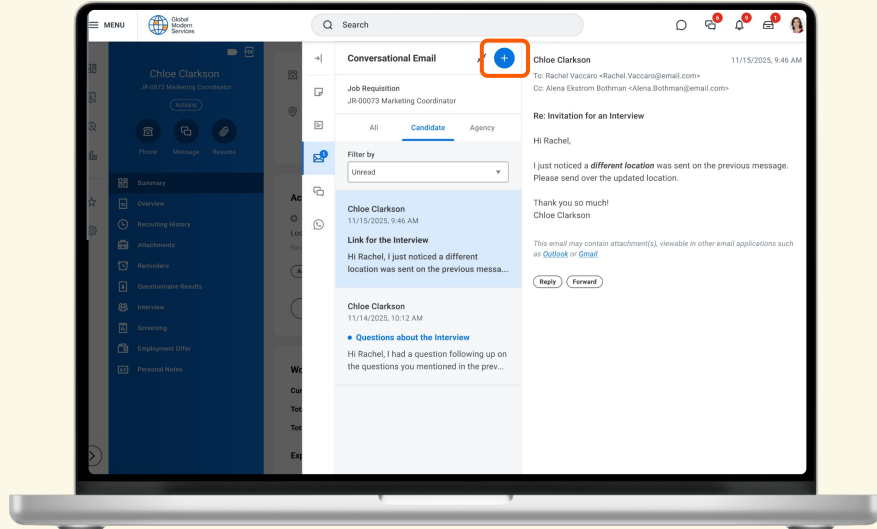
Open this email on Outlook

Reply

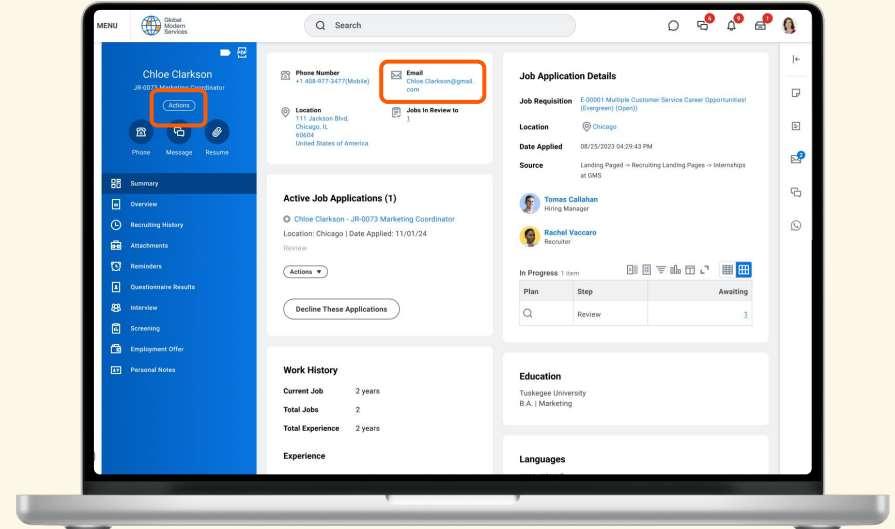
Forward

Sending New Emails

Because of the existing email functionality, many participants did not notice the blue plus button to send a new email.



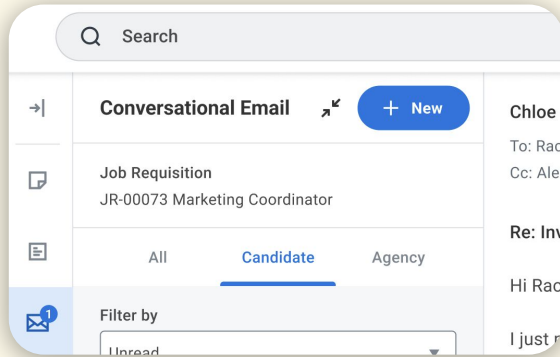
Expected



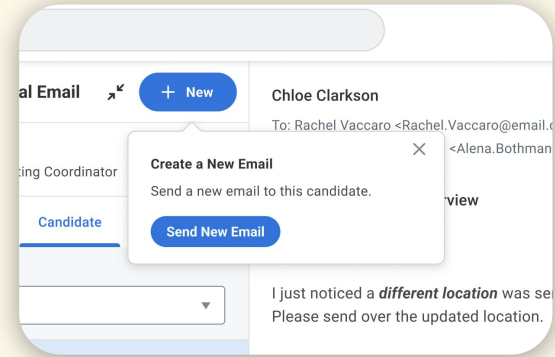
Where some users would click

Sending New Emails

Recommendations



More affordance (I.e. adding Text to the button) to indicate new email



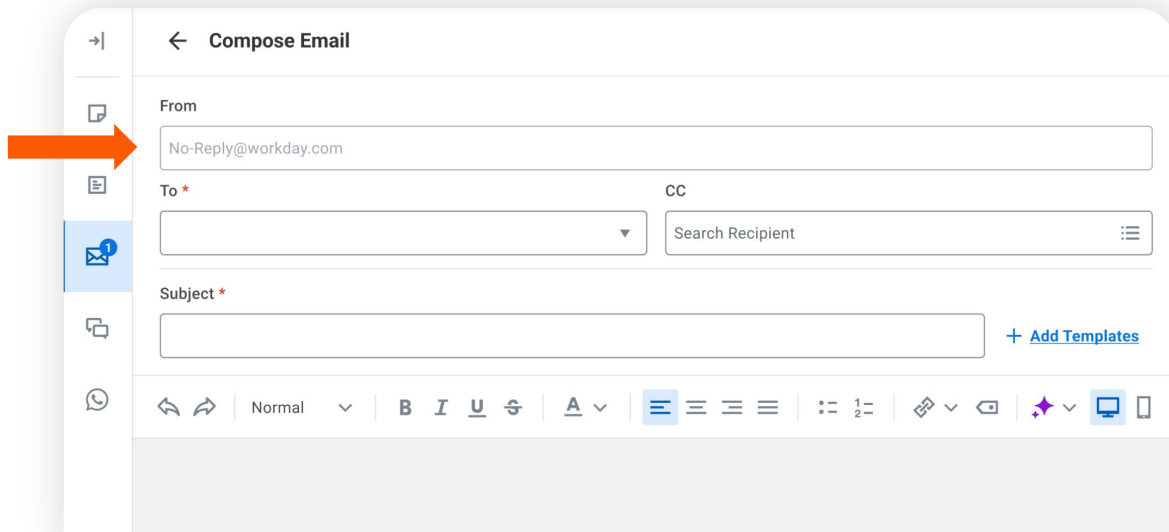
Feature highlight on starting a new email

From Email Field

All 10/10 recruiters said it is required to be able to change the from field email address.

Typically when...

- Dispositioning => No-Reply, Non-configurable email
- Moving the candidate forward => Requires personal work email

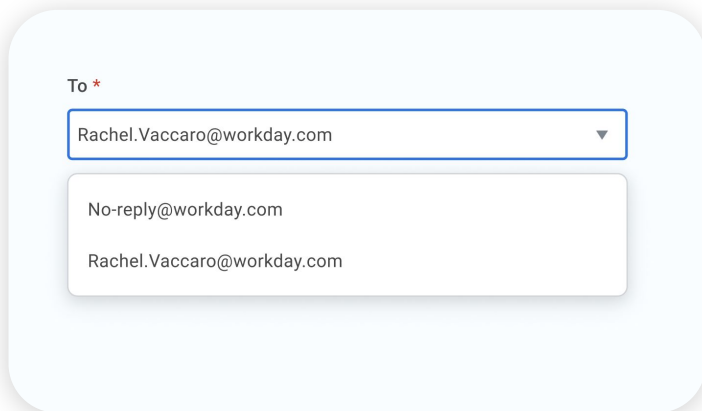


The screenshot shows a 'Compose Email' window. On the left is a sidebar with icons for a list, a document, an email (highlighted with a blue background), a document, and a chat bubble. An orange arrow points from the email icon in the sidebar to the 'From' field in the compose form. The 'From' field contains the text 'No-Reply@workday.com'. Below it are the 'To' and 'CC' fields. The 'To' field has a dropdown arrow and a red asterisk. The 'CC' field has a search bar labeled 'Search Recipient' and a list icon. Below these is the 'Subject' field with a red asterisk and a '+ Add Templates' link. At the bottom is a rich text editor toolbar with icons for undo, redo, text color, bold, italic, underline, strikethrough, link, unlink, bulleted list, numbered list, indent, outdent, link icon, unlink icon, and a blue square icon.

From Email Field

Recommendations

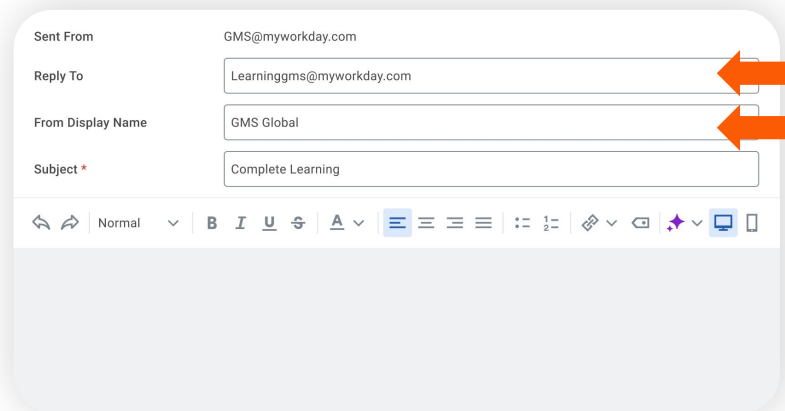
For MVP, we should explore being able to change this from field as it is a required use case for most, if not all recruiters.



The image shows a light blue rounded rectangle representing an email composition interface. At the top, it says "To *". Below this is a text input field containing "Rachel.Vaccaro@workday.com" with a small downward arrow on the right. Below the input field is a white rounded rectangle containing two email addresses: "No-reply@workday.com" and "Rachel.Vaccaro@workday.com".

Ideal for MVP:

User is able to select from email between no-reply email and personal work email.



The image shows a light gray rounded rectangle representing an email composition interface. It has four fields: "Sent From" with the value "GMS@myworkday.com", "Reply To" with the value "Learninggms@myworkday.com", "From Display Name" with the value "GMS Global", and "Subject *" with the value "Complete Learning". Each of the three input fields has a small orange arrow pointing to its right side. Below the fields is a rich text editor toolbar with various icons for text formatting and alignment.

Minimum to consider for MVP:

Message Builder's customizable "Reply To" and "From Display Name" fields

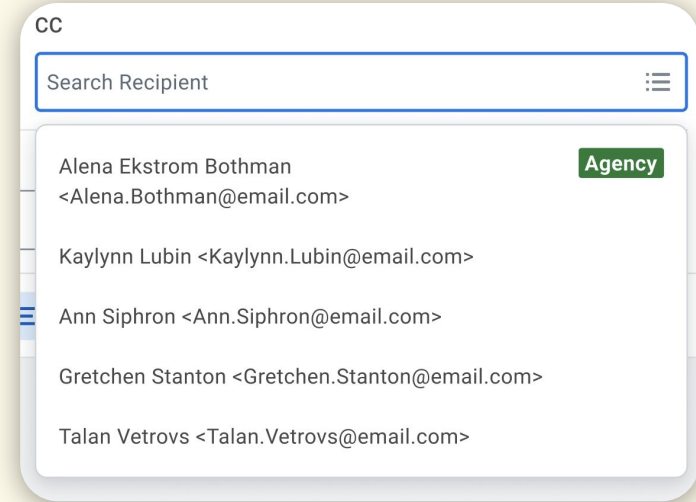
CC Fields

Most of the CC field use cases are **internal**.

- Hiring managers
- Recruiters covering for them while on PTO
- Colleagues who should be informed
- Benefits specialists, etc.

There are a few CC field use cases that are **external**, although not common.

- Additional candidate email (in case of .edu)
- External recruiters when hiring contractors (US)
- Agency users (Japan) - Covered



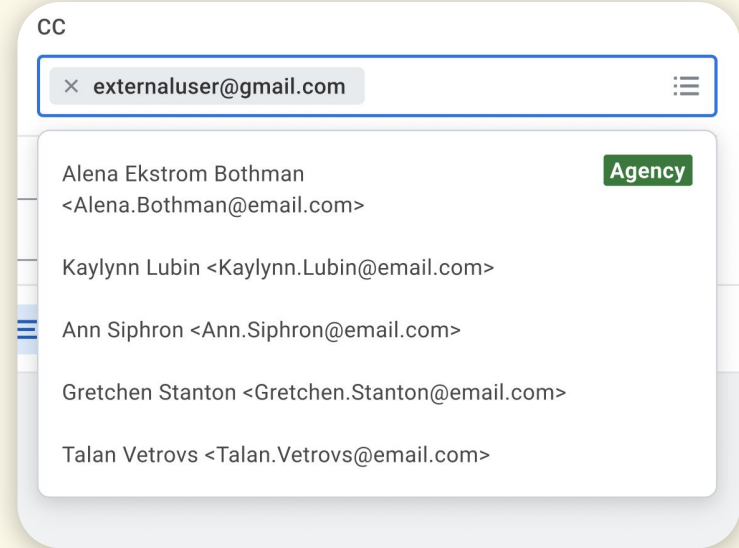
The image shows a user interface for a 'CC' (Carbon Copy) field. At the top, there is a search bar labeled 'Search Recipient' with a blue border and a menu icon on the right. Below the search bar is a list of email addresses. The first entry is 'Alena Ekstrom Bothman' with the email address '<Alena.Bothman@email.com>' and a green 'Agency' tag to its right. The other entries are 'Kaylynn Lubin <Kaylynn.Lubin@email.com>', 'Ann Siphron <Ann.Siphron@email.com>', 'Gretchen Stanton <Gretchen.Stanton@email.com>', and 'Talan Vetrovs <Talan.Vetrovs@email.com>'. The list is enclosed in a light gray rounded rectangle.

Search Recipient
Alena Ekstrom Bothman <Alena.Bothman@email.com> Agency
Kaylynn Lubin <Kaylynn.Lubin@email.com>
Ann Siphron <Ann.Siphron@email.com>
Gretchen Stanton <Gretchen.Stanton@email.com>
Talan Vetrovs <Talan.Vetrovs@email.com>

CC Fields

Recommendations

Consider allowing external emails within the CC field as an enhancement in the future.



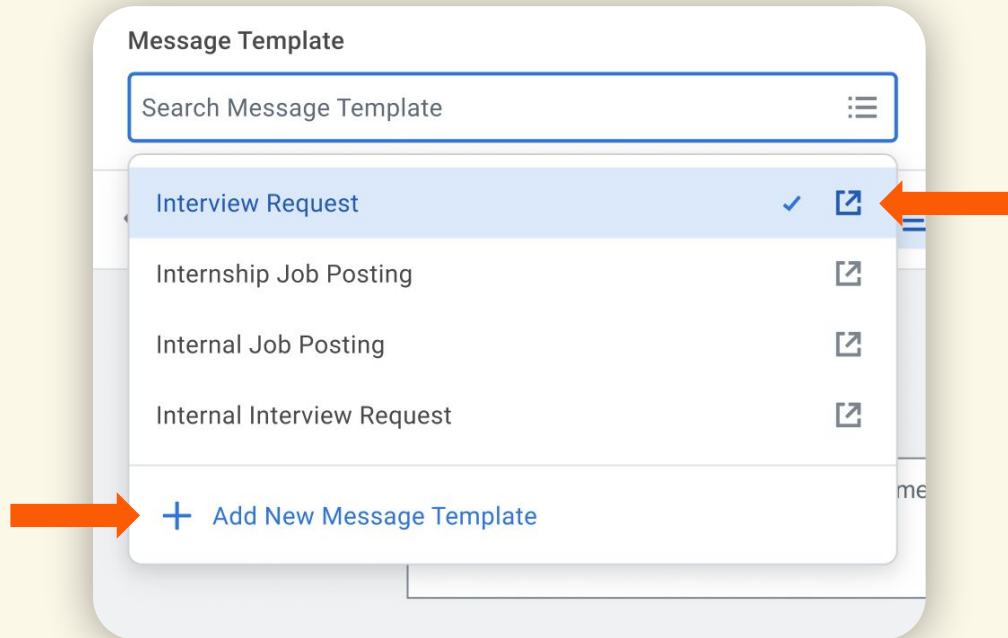
The image shows a screenshot of an email client's 'CC' field. At the top, the text 'CC' is displayed. Below it is a search bar containing the text 'externaluser@gmail.com' with a close button (X) on the left and a menu icon (three horizontal lines) on the right. Below the search bar is a list of suggested contacts. Each contact entry consists of the contact's name, their email address in angle brackets, and a green 'Agency' tag on the right side. The contacts listed are:

- Alena Ekstrom Bothman <Alena.Bothman@email.com>
- Kaylynn Lubin <Kaylynn.Lubin@email.com>
- Ann Siphron <Ann.Siphron@email.com>
- Gretchen Stanton <Gretchen.Stanton@email.com>
- Talan Vetrovs <Talan.Vetrovs@email.com>

Message Templates

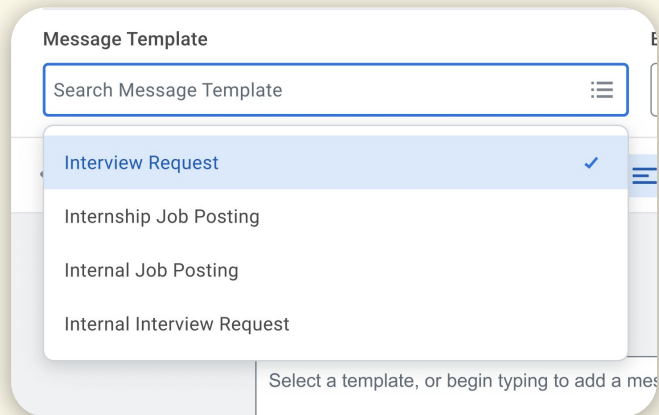
Most recruiters do **NOT** have access to **Add or Modify message templates** for security reasons. TA ops team typically manages.

Signatures/Personal templates were mentioned a few times as a way to personalize the emails sent out to candidates.

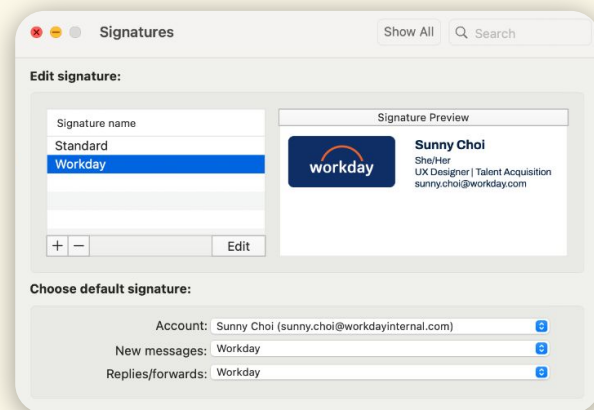


Message Templates

Recommendations

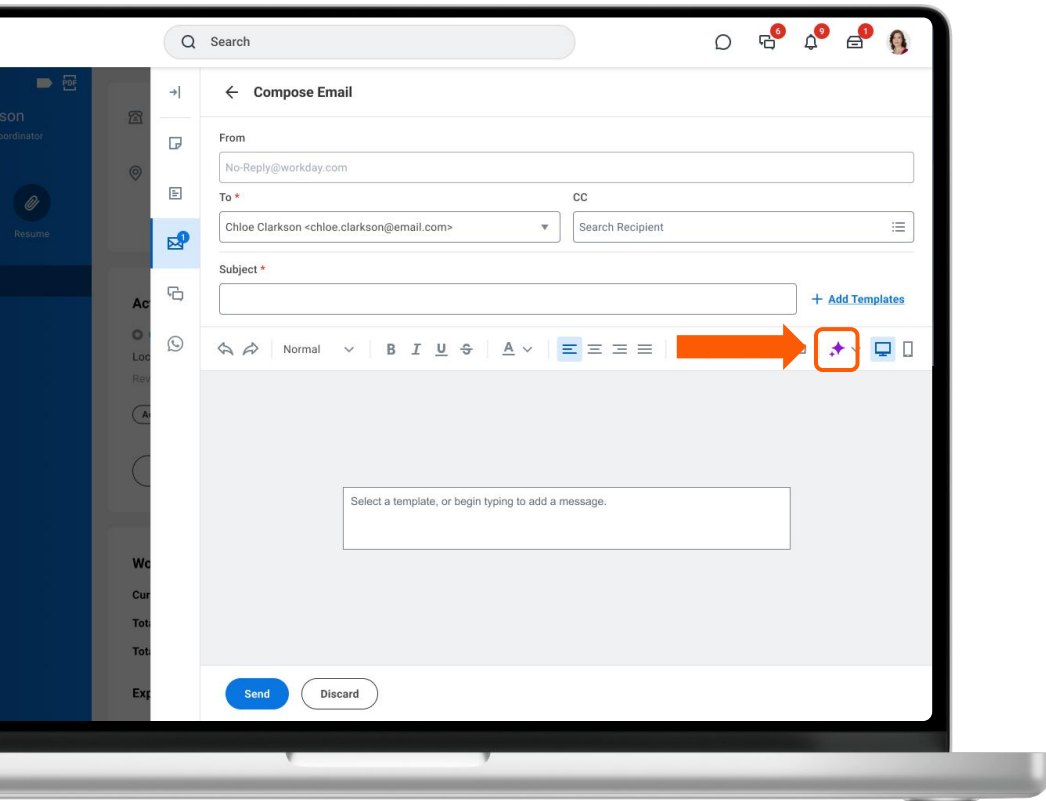


Simplify by removing Add/Modify functionalities.



Consider in the future providing signature, and Personal templates/Saved emails.

AI Assistant



Majority of participants answered that the purple sparkle icon = **AI assistant** and that they **currently use AI tools** today to craft emails.

Expected AI functionalities:

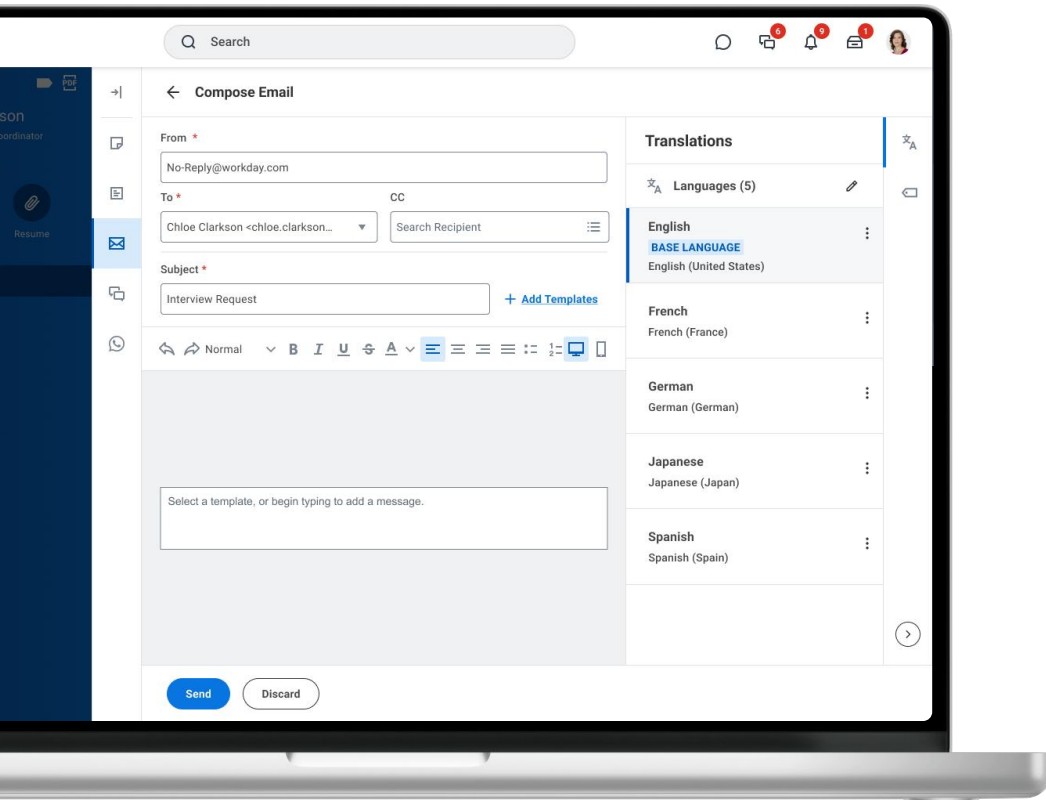
- Spell & Grammar check
- Write with specific tones
- Bullet points into paragraphs
- Pulling in **specific information from Workday** that a recruiter does not know the answer to.
 - Ex. If a candidate is asking about specific benefit, being able to pull that info in from Workday

Translations

- Most participants mentioned that there were recruiters who **often translate emails to communicate** with candidates.
- For North America, **Canada** was mentioned the most as they speak **French & English**.
- Most cases are covered by recruiters who are **bilingual**, but Japanese customers mentioned use of **AI tools** (Gemini, ChatGPT) to translate.
- One recruiter also mentioned that they would **change the Workday UI setting** to French in order to get access to French message templates.

AI & Translations

Recommendations



Consider enhancing with Message Builder's AI and Translation features in the future once available.

Recommendation Summary

Critical for MVP

- From Field Modification

Should Have's

- Attachments Viewable in Workday
- Email Threads
- External CC Recipients

Future Opportunities

- Signatures / Personal Templates
- AI Assistant
- Translations

Research Opps/Open Questions

- Syncing sent & received emails with Outlook and Gmail
 - Syncing important/flagged/read status with Outlook and Gmail
- Handling multiple job requisitions

*Does not include minor UX changes

SUS (System Usability Scale)

Measure of **perceived usability** on a scale of 1 through 5.

1=Strongly Disagree

5=Strongly Agree

4.3

I think that I would like to use this system frequently.

Best: 5

4.4

I thought the system was easy to use.

Best: 5

4.0

I would feel very confident using the system.

Best: 5

2.2

Best: 1

I would need to learn a lot of things before I could use this system.

Next Steps

- **UX** to make adjustments to the high fidelity designs based on feedback.
 - Start working on detailed documentation of the designs. (Specs, etc.)
- **Engineering** to provide insight into technical feasibility of suggested functionalities.
- **Product** to finalize MVP scope based on feedback.
- **OE Team** to help answer any open questions.

Thank you!

UX Design

Sunny Choi

Research Consultant

Christine Wozniak

PM

David Denham